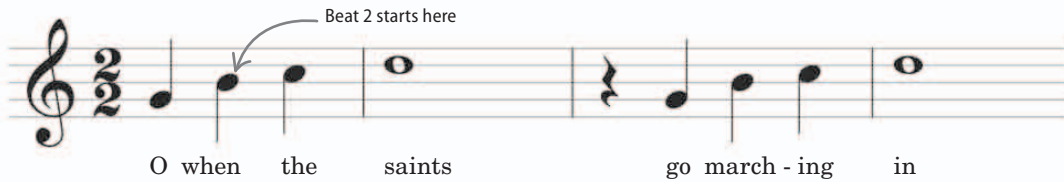


Opening incomplete measures

Here are examples of melodies in which the initial incomplete measure is either less than a whole beat (as in “Papageno’s Song”) or more than a whole beat (as in “When the Saints Go Marching in”). They are not exactly upbeats, but the feel is similar, leading into the strong first beat of the next measure.



◁ “When the Saints Go Marching In”

This famous jazz tune can be notated in different ways—most often in 2/2, as shown here, with the melody beginning halfway through the first beat.

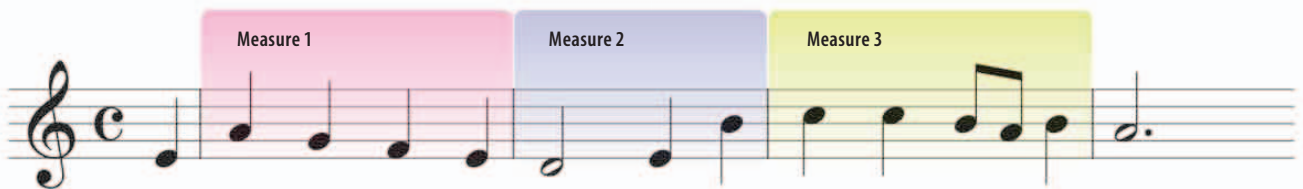


◁ Papageno’s Song from *The Magic Flute*

In this tune by Mozart, introducing the bird-catcher Papageno, the first two semiquavers are the second half of the upbeat.

Measure numbers

Upbeats are not counted when numbering measures; measures are counted from the first full measure in a piece. Here is the opening of the “Passion Chorale,” a Lutheran hymn tune used by Bach in the *St. Matthew Passion* and other works, showing the measure numbers.



▽ “Passion Chorale”

As shown in this opening from Bach’s “Passion Chorale,” measure numbers always start from the first full measure.

Endings

Many pieces that start with an upbeat also end with a balancing, incomplete measure, so that there is a standard number of measures. The “Passion Chorale” begins on an upbeat, as shown above, and ends with a dotted half note that balances the opening.



The end of a piece of music is shown by a final double bar line—a thin, ordinary bar line followed by a thick one.

◁ “Passion Chorale”

To balance an opening incomplete measure with a closing incomplete measure, as shown here, is common, but not an absolute rule.